

Bounce the Puppy's Gentle Paws

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Bounce was a golden puppy. He loved to bounce. He bounced in the morning. He bounced at noon. He bounced all afternoon. Boing! Boing! Boing! Bounce loved his friends. He loved Nina the newt. He loved Sammy the sparrow. But when Bounce got excited, he bounced too hard. He once bounced right over Nina's sandcastle. SPLAT! He once bounced Sammy's twig nest. Oh no! Bounce felt terrible. "I am too bouncy," he said. "I hurt my friends' things." He felt ashamed. His ears drooped low.



Nina the newt waddled over. She was not angry. She was just a little sad about her castle. "Bounce," she said kindly. "You have the happiest feet I know." "But can you learn gentle paws?" Bounce nodded hard. His tail wagged slowly. "I want to try," he said. Nina smiled. "Then remember this," she said. "Soft paws, kind paws." "Soft paws, kind paws." Bounce repeated it carefully. "Soft paws, kind paws." It became his practice song.



Nina taught him the tiptoe walk. "Step soft, like a whisper," she said. Bounce tried. Step, step, step. His paws barely made a sound. "Soft paws, kind paws," he whispered. He tiptoed around the sandcastle. Not one grain of sand moved! Nina clapped. "You did it!" she cheered. Bounce felt proud. He felt gentle inside. He practiced all morning. Tiptoe past the flowers. Tiptoe past the nest. Soft paws, kind paws.



Can you tiptoe like Bounce? Stand up and try: step, step, step. Soft paws, kind paws. Now sit back down, very gently. That afternoon, Bounce rebuilt the sandcastle with Nina. He placed each grain with care. Soft paws, kind paws. Sammy the sparrow landed on his head. Bounce stayed perfectly still. He was gentle all day long.



At sunset, Bounce felt sleepy and calm. He curled up in his basket. Nina snuggled against his soft fur. "You have the gentlest paws," she whispered. Bounce wagged his tail once, slowly. "Soft paws, kind paws," he yawned. The house grew quiet. The stars twinkled through the window. And Bounce slept without one single bounce.

Moral: *Gentle paws show friends how much you care.*

The End